



PRACTICAL TASK • MARKETING ASSOCIATE

PLAYER ONE

An agentic booth where
the fact that **nobody** is
standing in it is the
argument.

POL FERRERES

BIG DATA LDN • 23-24 SEPT 2026

OLYMPIA GRAND HALL

A SHORT QUEUE



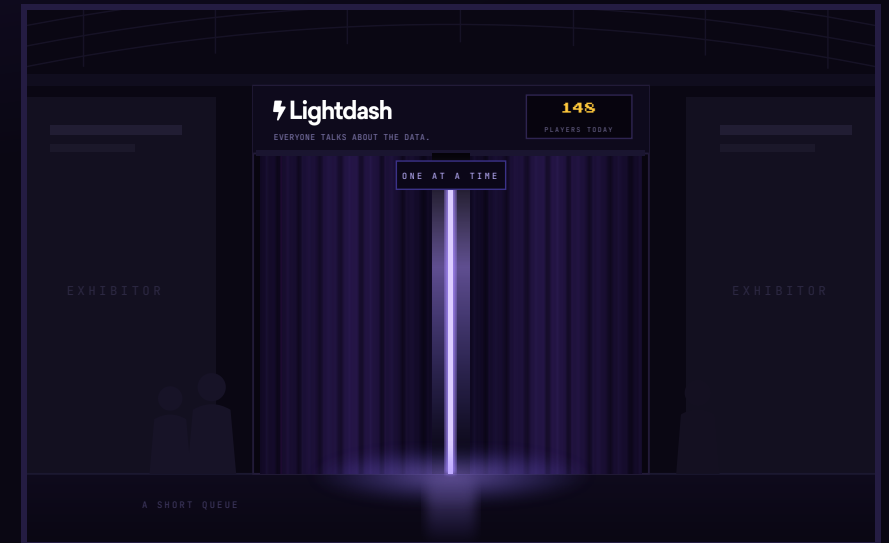


Everything after this page is the reasoning. The film is the thing itself: a closed black cabinet in the middle of a trade-show floor, one person going in, ninety seconds, and the counter outside ticking over as they walk out.

A booth that only lets
one person in at a time —
because that is exactly what your
BI licence does to your company.

Physically: a small black cabinet with a **curtain across the entrance**, a slit of violet light escaping the gap, a counter on the fascia climbing all day, and a plate reading **ONE PERSON AT A TIME**. Every other stand in the hall is open-plan and staffed. This one is shut.

The queue is the argument, the curtain is the argument, the counter is the argument. It is the only version of this brief where **having nobody on the stand is the proof rather than the constraint**.



FROM TEN FEET AWAY • 0:00

There is nobody to be sold to and nothing to be captured by — which is exactly why a technical crowd walks toward it. The exclusion creates the pull; the queue makes it legible from across the aisle.

OUR BRAND ALREADY SPEAKS 8-BIT.

Our campaign already runs on a pixel/arcade language — right down to the **pixelating bolt** sitting in our own public asset library. So I haven't invented a look. This takes the one we are already paying to build and makes it physical.

A separate event identity would have been the more impressive-looking answer and the more expensive one: a second brand for us to design, sign off and then throw away on 25 September.

THE ONLY NEW THING HERE IS THE MECHANIC

REF · LIGHTDASH-BOLT-PIXELATING.GIF · OUR OWN PUBLIC ASSET LIBRARY

REASON 01

Recognition at ten feet

Anyone who has already seen our campaign recognises the stand before reading a word of it. A brand-new concept would spend its first three seconds explaining itself — and three seconds is our whole budget in a hall this loud.

REASON 02

Nothing gets thrown away

Screens, type, palette and sound all come out of the system we already have. The booth software is a web page in the same design language, so we keep using it as a landing page after the show.

REASON 03

The metaphor was already there

An arcade cabinet is a machine that lets **one player in at a time** and wants a coin before it shows you anything. That is our licensing argument — it was already sitting inside our own brand.

EVERY BI TOOL SELLS ACCESS BY THE HEAD.

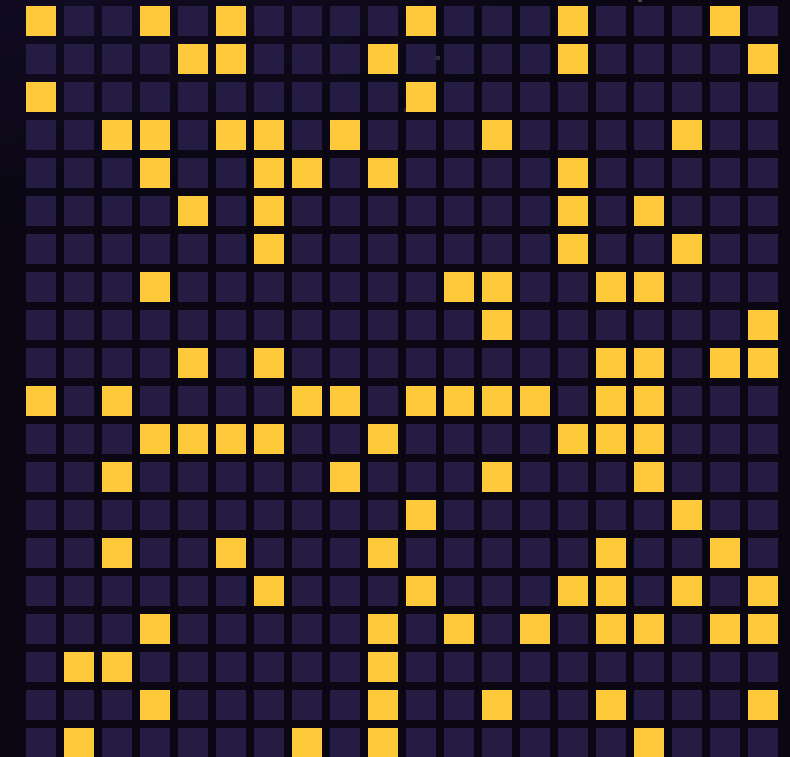
A 400-person company almost never buys 400 seats. BARC put it at **25% of employees** across 214 companies — about a hundred licences, and three hundred people who queue for an analyst to build it for them. That is not a budgeting accident; it is what per-seat pricing is designed to produce.

Microsoft states the rule plainly: “On F SKUs smaller than F64, each user viewing Power BI content must have Pro, PPU, or an individual trial.”

BARC also note it is “minimal growth in the past seven years”. We have no per-seat price, because metrics live in the customer’s own dbt project in Git — the seat was never our unit. **Everyone talks about the data. How many people can actually use it?**

SOURCES • BARC, “STRATEGIES FOR DRIVING ADOPTION AND USAGE WITH BI AND ANALYTICS”, 2022, 214 COMPANIES
MICROSOFT LEARN, FABRIC LICENCES • CHECKED 3 SEPT 2026

NOTE • 2022 IS THE NEWEST PROPERLY ATTRIBUTED ADOPTION FIGURE I COULD FIND. NEWER NUMBERS ONLINE CITE NO STUDY,
SO I DID NOT USE THEM. IF LIGHTDASH HOLDS BETTER OR INTERNAL DATA, THE BOOTH TAKES IT FROM ONE CONFIG
LINE.



■ CAN OPEN A DASHBOARD ■ CANNOT

100 OF 400

Big Data LDN fills the Olympia Grand Hall with roughly 15,000 people, 180 exhibitors and 300+ speakers across 16 theatres. The organisers describe the audience as **”highly technical, pragmatic”**. So the hook is universal — a licence question anyone can answer — and the **payload forks**: the commercial argument for buyers, the architectural one for engineers.

PRIMARY • THE STOPPER

Head of Data / Analytics

Owens the tooling budget. Already being asked why they can’t just point an AI at the warehouse. Knows exactly how many seats they bought and is slightly embarrassed by the number.

Gets: the cost of letting everyone in.

PRIMARY • THE SCEPTIC

Analytics / Data Engineer

dbt in production, opinions about semantic layers, allergic to booth staff. Will not queue for a pitch but will queue for a well-made machine that respects their time.

Gets: metrics as YAML in Git, reviewed in a PR.

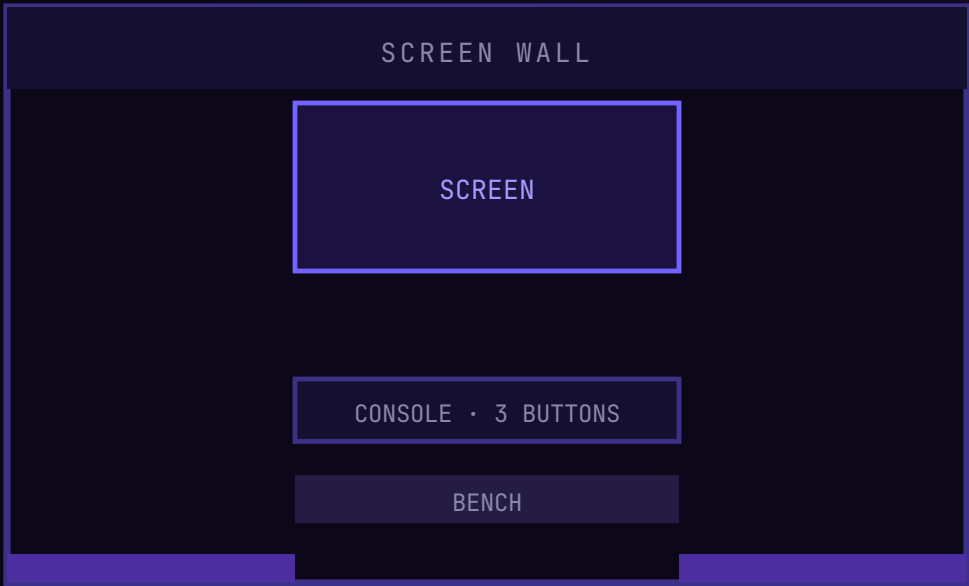
SECONDARY

The 388

Ops, finance, marketing, CS — people at the show who *are* the locked-out headcount. They validate the premise in person and become the internal pressure later.

Gets: a number to take to their data team.

PLAN VIEW



Enough usable interior for a bench, a console and a screen — nothing more. Matte black starfield panels, deep violet velvet curtains, one violet light source inside so the space reads as a cabinet rather than a meeting room.

THE KIT

SCREEN	One large display running a web page in kiosk mode . No bespoke hardware, no app.
INPUT	Three (occasionally four) large arcade buttons wired as a USB keyboard — keys 1/2/3/4. Nothing to learn.
CAPTURE	An NFC tag in the console : they tap their own phone and it opens a one-field page. A sticker and a URL — no reader, no badge data, nothing that depends on the organisers. On-screen QR for phones without NFC.
SENSOR	A cheap presence sensor drives the outside counter and the occupied / free light.
CURTAIN	Motorised on a track, or manual with a weighted return. Opens at the end of the run.
STAFF	Zero. One of us on site each morning to power it up and refill the bench.



0:20 · THE CURTAIN CLOSES

You sit. You are given a number, not a greeting — the 148th person in today — and for ninety seconds nobody can see you.



0:28 · QUESTION 1 OF 3

Three arcade buttons, three bands. No keyboard, no form, no name. The band is enough — precision here would cost more than it buys.



0:48 · THE TURN

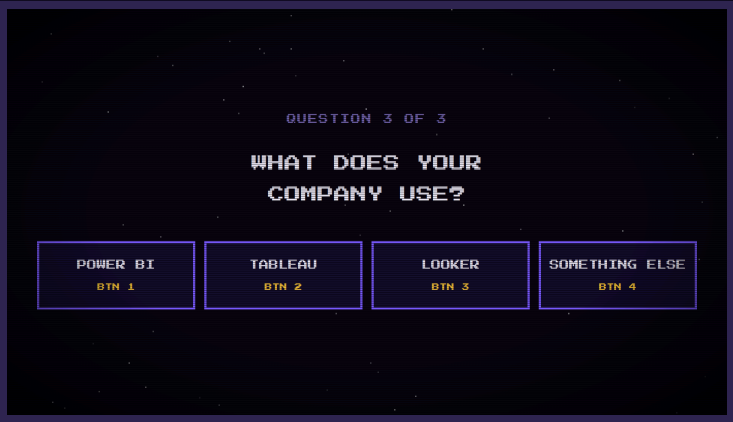
Their company drawn as 400 dots, a hundred lit — the industry average applied to the size they gave. **Three hundred colleagues who can't.** And if they think it's wrong, correcting it is what makes them reach for their phone.

0:00	0:20	0:28	0:48	1:00	1:08	1:15	1:24	1:30
STOP	CURTAIN	Q1 · SIZE	THE DOTS	FORK	Q3 · TOOL	THE COST	GAME OVER	PHONE · OPEN



1:00 · A REAL EXIT

They can leave here and still keep their result. Offering the exit is what makes staying feel like a choice rather than a trap.



1:08 · THE BRANCH

What follows is calculated from the tool **they actually named**, at that tool’s own published UK list price. Looker’s branch says the truest thing available: Google publishes no price at all.



1:15 · THE COST

They pay about **£1,080** today. Letting all 400 in costs **£4,320** on Power BI — or **£2,209** with us, or nothing at all self-hosted.

For an engineer the same fork leads to the architectural answer instead of the commercial one: **no per-seat price because metrics live in your dbt project, versioned in Git and reviewed in a pull request.** That branch ends at our GitHub repo and our community Slack, not at a demo booking.

· LIST PRICES CHECKED 3 SEPT 2026 · USD AT MICROSOFT'S PUBLISHED RATE 1 USD = 0.7362 GBP

0:00	0:20	0:28	0:48	1:00	1:08	1:15	1:24	1:30
STOP	CURTAIN	Q1 · SIZE	THE DOTS	FORK	Q3 · TOOL	THE COST	GAME OVER	PHONE · OPEN



1:24 · GAME OVER

The exit screen still lands the argument. Even a player who taps nothing walks out able to repeat the sentence — which is the brief’s actual test.



1:30 · THEY TAP OR SCAN WITH THEIR OWN PHONE

A short form opens in their hand, already showing the numbers they just gave. No rep’s tablet, no “can I grab your email”, and nothing that depends on the organisers’ badge system.

MAIN MECHANIC

Tap or scan — both live

An NFC sticker in the console, and the same code on screen for any phone that won’t tap. One page, two doors into it.

WHY THEIR PHONE

It updates the booth live

What they type lands in the booth’s database as they type it, so the screen can thank them by name before they leave.

FALLBACK

Physical keyboard

A small keyboard on the console. Slower, but it never depends on anyone else’s system.

0:00	0:20	0:28	0:48	1:00	1:08	1:15	1:24	1:30
STOP	CURTAIN	Q1 · SIZE	THE DOTS	FORK	Q3 · TOOL	THE COST	GAME OVER	PHONE · OPEN

MECHANISM 01

The constraint is the creative

"Nobody will be standing in it" is normally a problem to design around. Here it is the message: a booth about restricted access, with the access restricted. The one constraint we set ourselves becomes the proof.

MECHANISM 02

Scarcity in a hall built on abundance

180 stands all shouting at once. A closed curtain and a queue of two is the only thing on the floor that reads as *less* available — which at a trade show is the rarest signal there is.

MECHANISM 03

The disagreement is the hook

We apply a published average to the size they gave, and say so. Anyone who thinks it's wrong about *their* company has a reason to correct it — which is exactly when they pick up their phone.

MECHANISM 04

Nobody to perform for

The reason technical people avoid stands is the social cost, not the content. Removing the human removes the reason to swerve — and makes an honest answer to "how many seats do you have?" possible.

What we want them repeating to a colleague: "There's a booth where you sit alone and it works out how many people at your company can actually see the data — turns out about three hundred of us can't, and the tool we use charges by the head."

A REPORT NOBODY ELSE CAN SEND

Their own answers rendered back — headcount, locked-out number, what letting everyone in would cost on **their** tool — plus one thing no competitor can offer: **a live benchmark against every company that played that day.**

That benchmark only exists because of the booth. It is the reason to open the email, and the reason to open the follow-up when the show closes.

It ends in **three doors, with the free one first**: take it home free, join the community, or have us host it. Leading with the free door is the credibility of the whole thing.

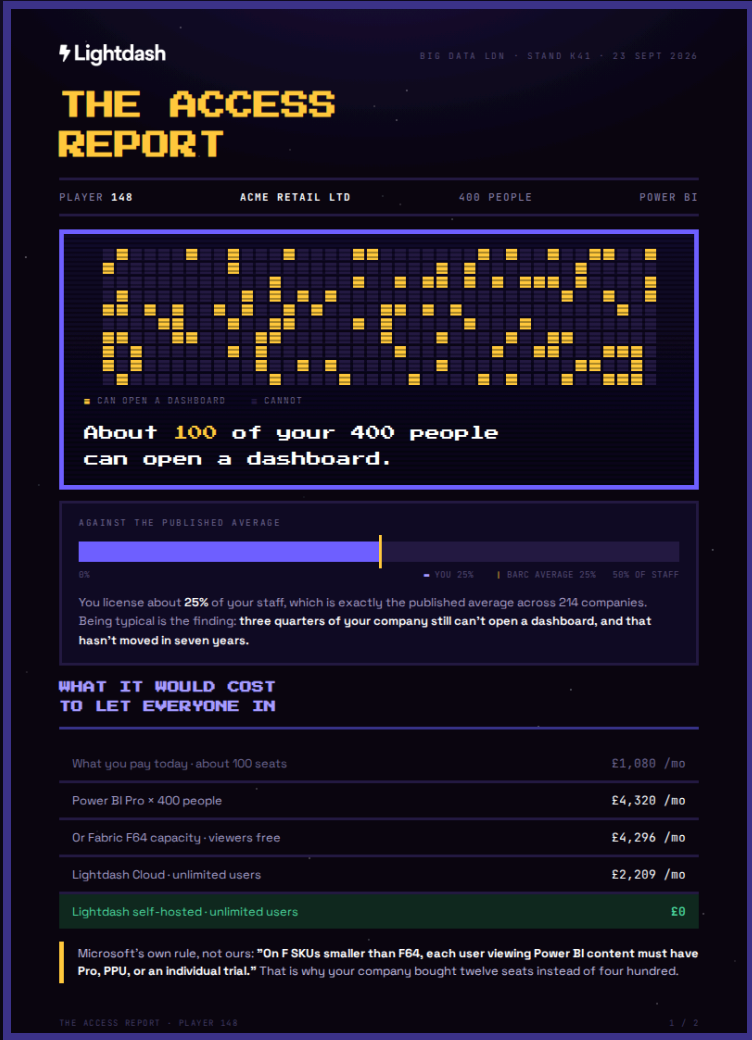
PAGE 1

Their dot grid, the benchmark, the cost of letting everyone in.

PAGE 2

Why there is no per-seat price, then the three doors.

NO GATE • NO "BOOK A DEMO" • ONE-CLICK UNSUBSCRIBE



NORTH STAR

QUALIFIED FOLLOW-UPS PER 100 STOPS

Not footfall, not scans, not staff-hours — there are no staff. The only question that matters is what share of the people who stopped were worth us talking to afterwards.

MEASURE	GOOD	GREAT
Completed runs over 2 days	300	500+
Stop → completion rate	60%	75%+
Completion → phone tap	50%	70%+
Qualified follow-ups / 100 stops	8	15+
Self-host installs traced to show	25	60+

All of it measured by the booth itself, with nobody counting: the software logs each run, the capture page logs each tap, UTM'd links log what happens after.

KILL ON DAY ONE · BY 13:00

1. **Under 30% of people who stop go in.** The curtain has become a barrier rather than an invitation. Fix: tie it open, run it as an open cabinet, keep the counter.
2. **Median run under 45 seconds.** They are bailing before the dots — the payoff arrives too late. Fix: cut to two questions.
3. **Phone-tap rate under 25%.** The exchange is not reading as fair. Fix: put the report preview on screen before the ask.

KILL THE WHOLE IDEA · AFTER THE SHOW

1. **The follow-up conversations do not mention the number.** If nobody repeats their own figure back to us, the argument didn't survive the walk to the next stand.
2. **Qualified follow-ups per 100 stops below 4.** Then a staffed stand with a good demo would have beaten us, and the concept loses on its own terms.

The honest risk we are taking: an unstaffed booth can't answer a follow-up question in the moment. That is a real cost to us, and the report plus the community link is how we pay it back.

PLAYER 148

YOU'RE IN.
IT'S JUST YOU.

3 QUESTIONS • 90 SECONDS

THE FULL RUN • KEYS 1 / 2 / 3 ARE THE ARCADE BUTTONS

[CLICK TO PLAY ►](#)



Every screen in this deck is a screenshot of software that already runs — one web page in kiosk mode, branching per tool, calculating from published prices. Which is why I can hand it over as a working link rather than a concept. **Click the screen, or scan the code.** Try to break it.

CHECK 01

Signal in the hall

Their phone has to load our page inside a hall with 15,000 people on it. Stand wifi they can join, or the page cached offline.

CHECK 02

Grand Hall build rules

Height, rigging and fire rules for an enclosed structure in a listed hall. Drapes need a flame-retardancy certificate.

Every other stand will
tell them what the
data can do.

This one asks how many
of them are allowed
to look at it.